

Which picks work

Returns filter study · NSE · backtest design period 31 Dec 2018 – 30 Sept 2025 · prepared 27 Sep 2026

SETTINGS TESTED

324 runs

DESIGN PERIOD

31 Dec 2018 – 30 Sept 2025

HELD BACK (SEALED)

1 Oct 2025 – today

COSTS

0.3% each way

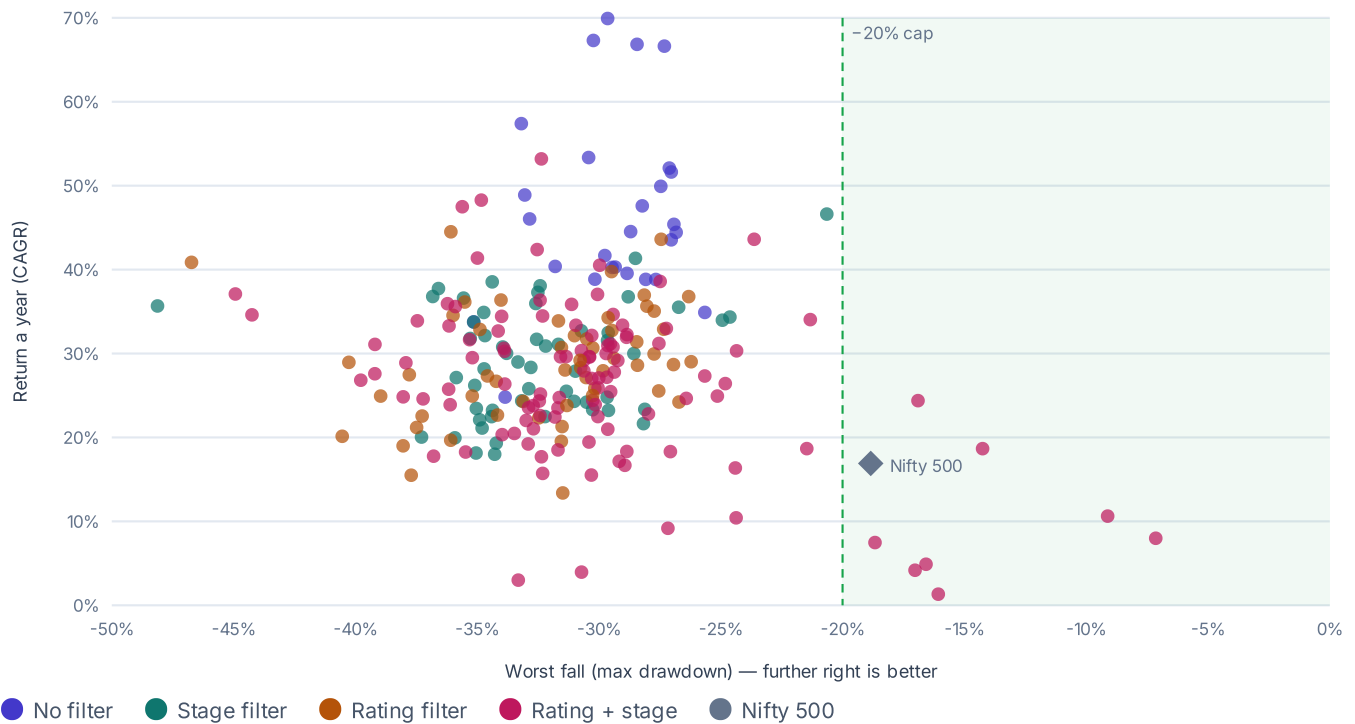
What we found

- 1 The unfiltered ranking beat every filter.** Across all settings, buying the top of the ranking with no filter returned a median +45.4% a year from 2019, against +26.8% to +31.0% for the stage filters. From mid-2023, when ratings exist, it returned +44.5% against +24.8% to +30.8% for every rating, stage and combined filter.
- 2 Filters did not make the ride smoother.** The median worst fall with no filter was –28.8% from mid-2023; the filters ranged –34.0% to –29.6%. Only 8 of 243 settings stayed inside the –20% limit, and every one is a combined filter that was either bought once and never rebalanced, or sat mostly in cash for want of stocks.
- 3 The deep falls are market sell-offs, made worse.** The three worst falls of the no-filter basket line up with the three Nifty 500 sell-offs (2020, 2022, late 2024 – early 2025), and the basket fell 1.1–2.2 times as far as the index in each. The small and mid-sized stocks the ranking favours fall harder than the market in a sell-off.
- 4 The gains come from strong years for smaller stocks.** The no-filter basket (Top 20, monthly) returned +134%, +139%, +75% and +78% in 2020, 2021, 2023 and 2024, but lagged the index in 2019 (–4% vs +8%) and in 2025 to September (–11% vs +2%).
- 5 Resetting to equal weight did better than holding as bought.** In 95 of 108 matched settings from mid-2023 (and 29 of 36 from 2019) the reset returned more — a median +3.6% a year — with about the same worst fall (–0.3%). Across many start dates the edge is much smaller (see "Weighting, across windows") so this is a mild preference, not a strong one.
- 6 Basket size and rebalance frequency matter much less than the filter.** Their medians sit within a few points of each other; see the table on page 3.
- 7 Starting on other dates does not change the answer.** Re-run as a fresh basket started every month and held 6 months, 1 year or 3 years, no filter beat the unfiltered ranking in more than 27% of the one-year windows, and none protected meaningfully in falling markets (at best about a point shallower). Of the drawdown rules only the trailing stop helped with any consistency, and only a little (see "Across many periods").

Read every figure as an upper bound. The design period is a backtest over the same years the model's weights were fitted on, so these returns are in-sample and flatter what to expect. The last 12 months are sealed: nothing in this report looks at them, so they can test whatever we decide next. Prices are adjusted for splits and bonuses but not dividends, on both sides.

Return against worst fall, every setting

Each dot is one setting from mid-2023 (243 runs): the filter, basket size, rebalance frequency and weighting. Up is more return, right is a shallower worst fall. The green band is the -20% limit.



By filter, 29 May 2023 – 30 Sept 2025

Filter	Settings	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Best worst fall	Beat Nifty	Trades won	Rounds short
All (no filter)	27	+44.5%	-28.8%	-25.7%	100%	55%	0%
Stage 2	27	+30.8%	-34.0%	-28.5%	100%	41%	0%
Buy+ · Stage 2	27	+29.2%	-30.6%	-27.5%	96%	46%	0%
Strong Buy	27	+28.7%	-31.7%	-26.2%	96%	52%	8%
Buy+	27	+28.6%	-30.5%	-27.3%	96%	48%	0%
Buy+ · Fresh S2	27	+27.3%	-29.6%	-9.1%	81%	42%	24%
Fresh S2	27	+27.1%	-31.0%	-20.6%	100%	39%	3%
Strong Buy · Stage 2	27	+25.7%	-33.0%	-24.4%	96%	47%	12%
Strong Buy · Fresh S2	27	+24.8%	-32.4%	-7.1%	74%	39%	90%
Nifty 500	—	+16.9%	-18.8%	—	—	—	—

Medians over every basket size, rebalance frequency and weighting for that filter. "Rounds short" is the share of rebalances where fewer stocks passed the filter than the basket holds; the rest waited in cash.

By filter, 31 Dec 2018 – 30 Sept 2025 (no ratings before May 2023)

Filter	Settings	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Best worst fall	Beat Nifty	Trades won	Rounds short
All (no filter)	27	+45.4%	-41.5%	-36.8%	100%	53%	0%
Stage 2	27	+31.0%	-39.7%	-35.5%	100%	44%	0%
Fresh S2	27	+26.8%	-38.4%	-17.6%	93%	40%	7%
Nifty 500	—	+14.4%	-38.3%	—	—	—	—

Settings

29 May 2023 – 30 Sept 2025

Setting	Runs	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Median return ÷ fall
Top 10	81	+29.6%	−32.6%	0.90
Top 20	81	+26.8%	−31.4%	0.86
Top 50	81	+30.8%	−29.5%	1.02
Never	27	+32.3%	−28.9%	1.12
Weekly	54	+28.8%	−31.4%	0.90
2 weeks	54	+27.6%	−30.4%	0.89
Monthly	54	+32.2%	−32.5%	0.95
Quarterly	54	+28.9%	−31.6%	0.92
Hold as bought	135	+27.1%	−30.4%	0.89
Reset to equal	108	+31.0%	−32.2%	0.99

31 Dec 2018 – 30 Sept 2025

Setting	Runs	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Median return ÷ fall
Top 10	27	+30.8%	−43.3%	0.75
Top 20	27	+31.0%	−40.4%	0.79
Top 50	27	+34.4%	−37.6%	0.93
Never	9	+26.8%	−39.8%	0.66
Weekly	18	+34.1%	−39.1%	0.89
2 weeks	18	+32.9%	−38.9%	0.92
Monthly	18	+35.9%	−40.0%	0.87
Quarterly	18	+29.4%	−40.2%	0.71
Hold as bought	45	+30.0%	−39.7%	0.79
Reset to equal	36	+35.4%	−39.9%	0.91

Each row is a median across every filter, so rows mix different filters. "Hold as bought" also includes the never-rebalanced runs; the matched comparison in finding 5, same filter, size and frequency, is the fairer test of the two weightings.

Highest returns, 29 May 2023 – 30 Sept 2025

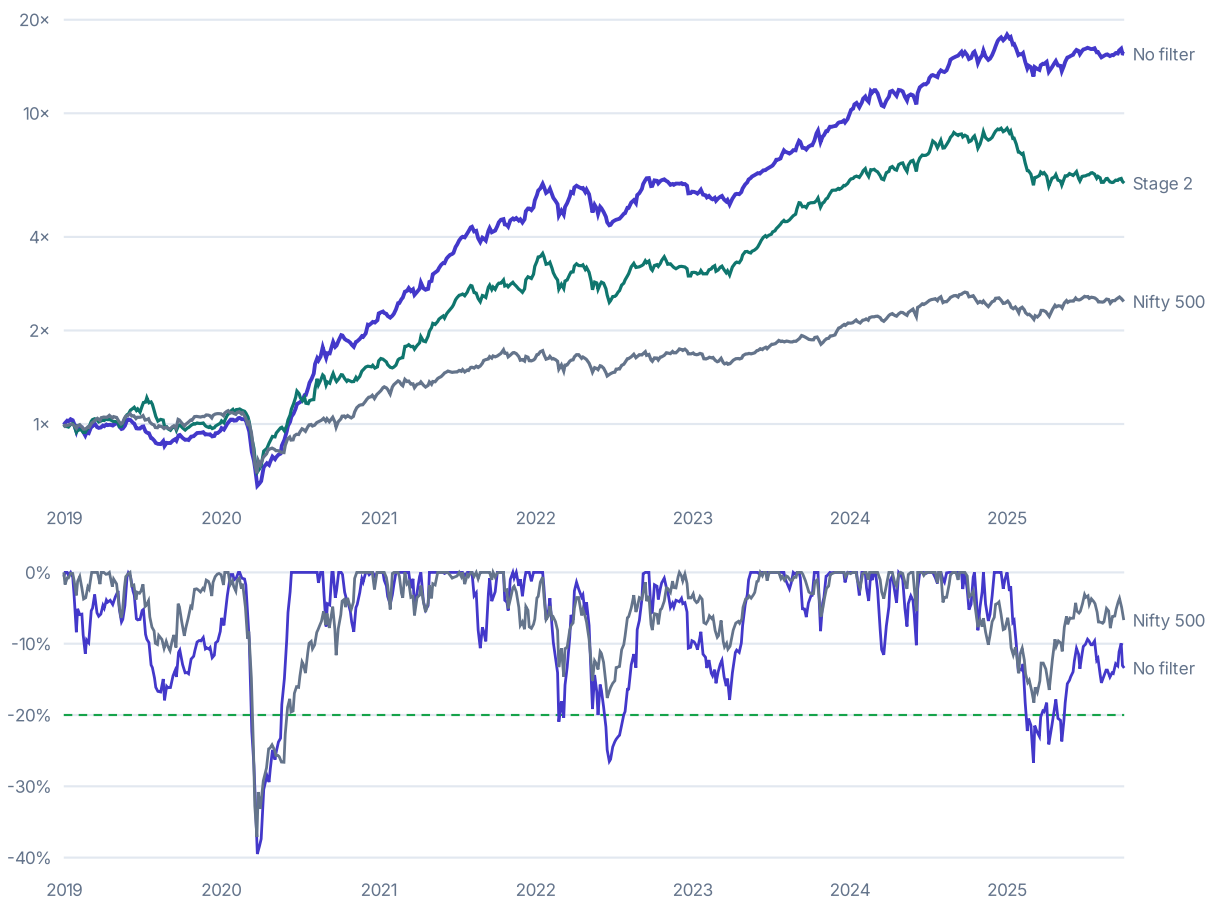
Setting	Return / yr	Worst fall	Return ÷ fall	Trades won	Rounds short
All (no filter) · Top 10 · 2 weeks · Reset to equal	+69.9%	−29.6%	2.36	59%	0/59
All (no filter) · Top 10 · Weekly · Reset to equal	+67.3%	−30.2%	2.23	57%	0/116
All (no filter) · Top 10 · 2 weeks · Hold as bought	+66.8%	−28.4%	2.35	59%	0/59
All (no filter) · Top 10 · Weekly · Hold as bought	+66.6%	−27.3%	2.44	57%	0/116
All (no filter) · Top 10 · Monthly · Reset to equal	+57.4%	−33.2%	1.73	60%	0/25
All (no filter) · Top 10 · Monthly · Hold as bought	+53.4%	−30.4%	1.75	60%	0/25
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 10 · Quarterly · Reset to equal	+53.2%	−32.4%	1.64	43%	8/10
All (no filter) · Top 20 · Weekly · Hold as bought	+52.1%	−27.1%	1.92	55%	0/116
All (no filter) · Top 20 · Weekly · Reset to equal	+51.6%	−27.0%	1.91	55%	0/116
All (no filter) · Top 20 · Monthly · Hold as bought	+49.9%	−27.5%	1.82	55%	0/25

Every setting inside the −20% limit

Setting	Return / yr	Worst fall	Return ÷ fall	Trades won	Rounds short
Buy+ · Fresh S2 · Top 20 · Never	+24.4%	−16.9%	1.44	— (held)	1/1
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 20 · Never	+18.7%	−14.3%	1.31	— (held)	1/1
Buy+ · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · Never	+10.6%	−9.1%	1.17	— (held)	1/1
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · Never	+8.0%	−7.1%	1.12	— (held)	1/1
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · Weekly · Hold as bought	+7.5%	−18.7%	0.40	36%	116/116
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · Monthly · Hold as bought	+4.9%	−16.6%	0.30	44%	25/25
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · 2 weeks · Hold as bought	+4.2%	−17.0%	0.25	36%	59/59
Strong Buy · Fresh S2 · Top 50 · Quarterly · Hold as bought	+1.3%	−16.1%	0.08	28%	10/10

Where the falls come from

Growth of ₹1 from 31 Dec 2018 (log scale), and how far each sat below its last peak.



No filter = All (no filter) · Top 20 · Monthly · Hold as bought. Stage 2 = Stage 2 · Top 20 · Weekly · Hold as bought. The dashed line is -20%.

The four worst falls of the no-filter basket

Fall	Peak → bottom	Back to peak	Basket	Nifty 500, same dates	Basket ÷ Nifty
1	19 Feb 2020 → 24 Mar 2020	15 Jun 2020	-41.5%	-36.2%	1.1×
2	17 Jan 2022 → 20 Jun 2022	9 Sept 2022	-29.1%	-17.9%	1.6×
3	3 Jan 2025 → 3 Mar 2025	not by 30 Sep 2025	-26.9%	-12.4%	2.2×
4	15 Sept 2022 → 28 Mar 2023	17 May 2023	-18.4%	-8.8%	2.1×

Year by year

Setting	2019	2020	2021	2022	2023	2024	2025*
All (no filter) · Top 20 · Monthly · Hold as bought	-4%	+134%	+139%	+5%	+75%	+78%	-11%
All (no filter) · Top 10 · Weekly · Hold as bought	-5%	+150%	+197%	-19%	+101%	+102%	-7%
Stage 2 · Top 20 · Weekly · Hold as bought	+1%	+55%	+110%	-6%	+97%	+44%	-32%
Fresh S2 · Top 20 · Weekly · Hold as bought	0%	+17%	+102%	+15%	+66%	+30%	-15%
Nifty 500	+8%	+17%	+30%	+3%	+26%	+15%	+2%

* 2025 runs to 30 Sep, the end of the design period.

The drawdown study, as agreed before it was run

No filter and no setting on the page keeps the worst fall inside -20% without giving up most of the return, because the falls are the market's, amplified. So the next study changes *how the basket is run* and leaves the scores alone, as agreed. To keep it honest, the rules, their numbers and the way we choose are fixed below before any of them is tested; nothing gets tuned after the results are seen.

Starting point. The no-filter ranking, Top 20, in two forms: weekly with reset to equal (the strongest settings above) and monthly held as bought (fewer trades). Same costs, same design period.

R1 Market switch. Each week, classify the Nifty 500 with the rule the model already uses for ratings (above or below its 200-day average, the average's 20-day slope, a 2% band). When it is risk-off, sell everything and hold cash; buy back at the first weekly check that is not risk-off.

R2 Small-cap switch. The same rule on the equal-weight index of every ranked stock, which tracks the smaller stocks the basket actually holds. In Jan – Mar 2025 the basket fell -27% while the Nifty 500 fell only -12%; a Nifty-based switch may never trigger on a fall like that. (This index starts Nov 2018, so the switch can first act around Sep 2019.)

R3 Stop per stock. Sell a holding at the next close after it closes 20% below its highest close since it was bought. Its slot waits in cash until the next rebalance, when it can be refilled by the normal rules.

R4 R2 and R3 together.

How we choose. Of the 8 runs (4 rules × 2 starting points), the one with the highest return a year among those whose worst fall stays inside -20%. If none does, the one with the shallowest worst fall among those that still beat the Nifty 500.

How we confirm. The chosen rule and its starting point without the rule are then run once on the sealed 12 months. We adopt it only if, there too, its worst fall is at least a third smaller than the starting point's and it still returns at least as much as the Nifty 500. If it fails, we don't adopt it, and the sealed period is spent.

Approved as written, with full cash on risk-off, and extended at your request to every combination of R1, R2 and R3 (8 per starting point, 16 runs). The numbers were not tuned.

What happened

Design period, 16 runs

Start	Rules	Return / yr	Worst fall	Return ÷ fall	Weeks in cash	Stops
Weekly, reset	none	+50.8%	−48.0%	1.06	0%	0
Weekly, reset	R1	+37.3%	−35.6%	1.05	10%	0
Weekly, reset	R2	+43.5%	−30.1%	1.44	11%	0
Weekly, reset	R3	+49.5%	−41.9%	1.18	0%	259
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2	+37.3%	−30.7%	1.21	15%	0
Weekly, reset	R1 + R3	+37.0%	−29.9%	1.24	10%	220
Weekly, reset	R2 + R3	+42.5%	−26.5%	1.60	11%	220
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2 + R3	+36.1%	−27.8%	1.30	15%	207
Monthly, hold	none	+50.1%	−41.5%	1.21	0%	0
Monthly, hold	R1	+33.7%	−30.4%	1.11	10%	0
Monthly, hold	R2	+41.7%	−29.1%	1.43	11%	0
Monthly, hold	R3	+49.9%	−27.6%	1.81	0%	266
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2	+34.1%	−30.4%	1.12	15%	0
Monthly, hold	R1 + R3	+33.9%	−29.0%	1.17	10%	233
Monthly, hold	R2 + R3	+40.3%	−27.6%	1.46	11%	235
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2 + R3	+33.0%	−29.0%	1.14	15%	221
<i>Nifty 500</i>		<i>+14.4%</i>	<i>−38.3%</i>			

No run stayed inside −20%. Under the fallback rule, the shallowest worst fall that still beat the Nifty 500 was **weekly, reset to equal, with the small-cap switch and the stop (R2 + R3)**: +42.5% a year and −26.5%, against −48.0% without rules. Almost all of that came from the 2020 crash; it barely changed the falls of 2022 and early 2025. That concern was written down before the sealed year was opened.

The sealed year, run once (6 Oct 2025 – 25 Sept 2026)

	Return	Worst fall	Weeks in cash	Stops
Weekly, reset, no rules	+8.98%	−15.3%	0%	0
Weekly, reset, R2 + R3 (chosen)	+1.02%	−17.3%	19%	14
<i>Nifty 500</i>	<i>−2.66%</i>	<i>−14.8%</i>		

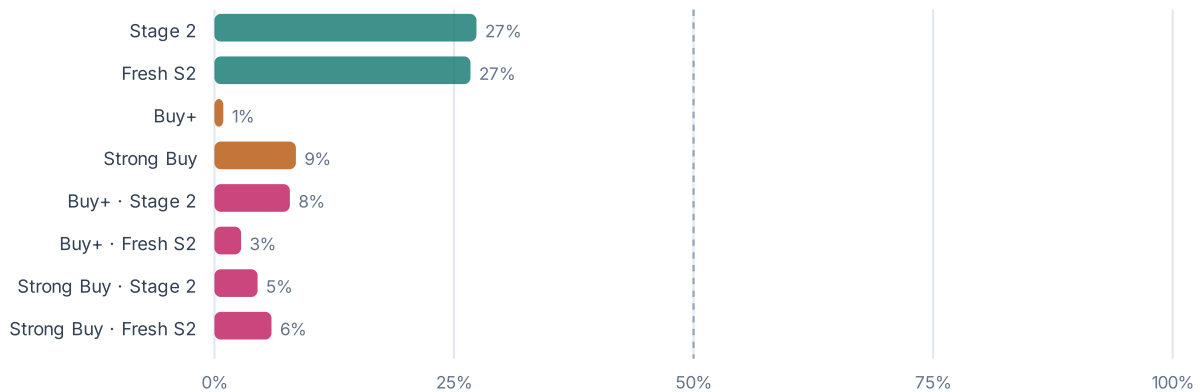
Not adopted. The rule needed a worst fall at least a third smaller than the plain basket's, and got a deeper one (−17.3% against −15.3%). It still beat the Nifty 500, but gave up about 8 points to the plain basket: in cash a fifth of the weeks and stopped out of 14 holdings, it missed rebounds without avoiding the November – March fall. The sealed year is now spent; a new rule can only be confirmed on data from here on.

Across many periods

Everything above rests on one start date per window. To check it isn't an accident of timing, the same tests were re-run as a fresh basket started at the first ranking of every month and held for 6 months, 1 year or 3 years — 80 overlapping one-year windows from Jan 2019 (from Jun 2023 for rating filters), through the end of the backtest on 10 Aug 2026. Settings: Top 10 and Top 20, weekly and monthly, both weightings. Each filter is compared with the unfiltered ranking over the same window at the same settings.

A window's market type was fixed before any result was seen, by the Nifty 500's yearly return over it: below 0% falling, 0–10% flat, above 10% rising. One-year windows: 15 falling, 27 flat, 38 rising. Every three-year window since 2019 was rising, so the three-year figures say nothing about bad markets.

How often each filter beat no filter, one-year windows



One-year windows

Filter	Runs	Median return / yr	Bad case (1 in 10)	Median worst fall	Fell past -20%	Beat Nifty	Beat no filter
All (no filter)	640	+44.6%	-4.6%	-19.8%	49%	84%	—
Stage 2	640	+35.3%	-11.6%	-19.3%	47%	75%	27%
Fresh S2	640	+30.3%	-10.9%	-19.1%	47%	78%	27%
Buy+	216	-1.3%	-19.7%	-19.5%	45%	40%	1%
Strong Buy	200	+5.1%	-13.6%	-19.7%	49%	52%	9%
Buy+ · Stage 2	216	+2.3%	-13.1%	-20.1%	52%	49%	8%
Buy+ · Fresh S2	216	-2.8%	-21.5%	-24.1%	71%	32%	3%
Strong Buy · Stage 2	200	+1.5%	-20.7%	-20.8%	52%	46%	5%
Strong Buy · Fresh S2	168	-3.7%	-22.6%	-23.5%	64%	30%	6%

Bad case: the return a year that one window in ten fell below. Fell past -20%: share of windows whose worst fall was deeper than -20%. Rating filters have only 27 one-year windows (ratings start May 2023), so their figures are the least certain.

Falling markets only

If a filter earned its keep by protecting capital, it would show here. Six-month windows where the Nifty 500 fell (31 start dates):

Filter	Runs	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Beat no filter	Shallower fall than no filter	Median fall vs no filter
All (no filter)	248	-1.1%	-20.0%	—	—	—
Stage 2	248	-5.1%	-19.1%	56%	59%	+1.0 pts
Fresh S2	248	-6.8%	-17.2%	48%	65%	+1.3 pts
Buy+	88	-15.7%	-18.2%	18%	30%	-1.6 pts
Strong Buy	88	-15.0%	-18.5%	25%	34%	-1.4 pts
Buy+ · Stage 2	88	-9.5%	-18.5%	32%	27%	-1.5 pts
Buy+ · Fresh S2	88	-22.4%	-20.3%	13%	17%	-3.6 pts
Strong Buy · Stage 2	88	-12.8%	-17.7%	17%	32%	-1.1 pts
Strong Buy · Fresh S2	88	-24.5%	-18.4%	5%	34%	-1.9 pts

One-year windows where it fell (15 start dates):

Filter	Runs	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Beat no filter	Shallower fall than no filter	Median fall vs no filter
All (no filter)	120	+5.6%	-28.3%	—	—	—
Stage 2	120	-7.4%	-31.2%	28%	50%	+0.0 pts
Fresh S2	120	-2.6%	-30.7%	35%	56%	+1.3 pts
Buy+	48	-8.2%	-29.9%	0%	2%	-3.0 pts
Strong Buy	48	-4.6%	-28.9%	19%	29%	-2.3 pts
Buy+ · Stage 2	48	-5.5%	-27.4%	19%	31%	-1.5 pts
Buy+ · Fresh S2	48	-13.4%	-29.6%	8%	25%	-5.6 pts
Strong Buy · Stage 2	48	-9.0%	-28.2%	10%	31%	-1.5 pts
Strong Buy · Fresh S2	40	-8.0%	-26.8%	13%	38%	-3.0 pts

"Fall vs no filter" is in percentage points of worst fall; positive means shallower than no filter.

Weighting, across windows

Hold	Scope	Pairs	Reset returned more	Median difference / yr	Reset fell less	Median fall difference
6 months	No filter	344	47%	-0.2 pts	54%	+0.0 pts
6 months	Every filter	1784	56%	+0.6 pts	51%	+0.0 pts
1 year	No filter	320	52%	+0.2 pts	69%	+0.3 pts
1 year	Every filter	1568	61%	+1.1 pts	58%	+0.2 pts
3 years	No filter	224	58%	+0.7 pts	67%	+0.3 pts
3 years	Every filter	744	70%	+2.0 pts	67%	+0.9 pts

Reset to equal still comes out slightly ahead, but only slightly: with no filter it returned more in 52% of one-year windows, by a median +0.2 points a year, and fell less in 69%. The single-window "95 of 108" overstated it.

The drawdown rules, across windows

The same 16 rule combinations, each compared with its own starting point without rules over the same window.
One-year windows:

Start	Rules	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Fell past –20%	Return vs no rules	Fall vs no rules	Shallower than no rules	Falling markets: fall vs no rules
Weekly, reset	none	+45.2%	–18.3%	45%	—	—	—	—
Weekly, reset	R1	+22.1%	–19.9%	46%	–4.4 pts	0.0 pts	20%	0.0 pts
Weekly, reset	R2	+38.2%	–17.8%	41%	–4.3 pts	0.0 pts	19%	0.0 pts
Weekly, reset	R3	+44.0%	–18.0%	43%	–2.1 pts	+0.6 pts	79%	+0.8 pts
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2	+26.6%	–18.3%	41%	–7.8 pts	0.0 pts	21%	0.0 pts
Weekly, reset	R1 + R3	+23.4%	–19.1%	41%	–6.2 pts	+0.6 pts	64%	+0.8 pts
Weekly, reset	R2 + R3	+38.2%	–17.2%	38%	–7.0 pts	+0.6 pts	75%	+0.8 pts
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2 + R3	+27.1%	–17.1%	38%	–8.7 pts	+0.6 pts	63%	+0.8 pts
Monthly, hold	none	+55.6%	–18.2%	48%	—	—	—	—
Monthly, hold	R1	+24.4%	–20.1%	51%	–5.8 pts	0.0 pts	35%	+0.2 pts
Monthly, hold	R2	+43.4%	–17.6%	39%	–5.3 pts	0.0 pts	31%	+0.4 pts
Monthly, hold	R3	+43.8%	–16.5%	43%	–2.8 pts	+2.1 pts	81%	+5.2 pts
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2	+29.8%	–17.9%	43%	–9.3 pts	0.0 pts	35%	+0.3 pts
Monthly, hold	R1 + R3	+24.8%	–17.5%	39%	–9.0 pts	+1.9 pts	75%	+5.2 pts
Monthly, hold	R2 + R3	+35.5%	–16.0%	34%	–9.0 pts	+2.3 pts	75%	+5.2 pts
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2 + R3	+25.0%	–16.3%	34%	–11.3 pts	+2.2 pts	71%	+5.2 pts

Three-year windows:

Start	Rules	Median return / yr	Median worst fall	Fell past -20%	Return vs no rules	Fall vs no rules	Shallower than no rules	Falling markets: fall vs no rules
Weekly, reset	none	+65.7%	-27.0%	100%	—	—	—	—
Weekly, reset	R1	+49.1%	-27.0%	100%	-7.5 pts	0.0 pts	27%	—
Weekly, reset	R2	+57.9%	-24.0%	100%	-5.7 pts	0.0 pts	27%	—
Weekly, reset	R3	+64.0%	-26.4%	100%	-2.8 pts	+0.6 pts	100%	—
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2	+50.3%	-26.1%	100%	-10.1 pts	-1.0 pts	27%	—
Weekly, reset	R1 + R3	+48.3%	-24.9%	100%	-10.3 pts	+0.8 pts	54%	—
Weekly, reset	R2 + R3	+55.8%	-23.6%	100%	-7.5 pts	+0.4 pts	88%	—
Weekly, reset	R1 + R2 + R3	+48.0%	-26.3%	100%	-12.8 pts	-0.3 pts	46%	—
Monthly, hold	none	+59.1%	-29.1%	100%	—	—	—	—
Monthly, hold	R1	+45.7%	-30.2%	100%	-7.1 pts	-1.1 pts	38%	—
Monthly, hold	R2	+55.0%	-28.9%	100%	-6.3 pts	0.0 pts	48%	—
Monthly, hold	R3	+55.0%	-25.2%	100%	-4.6 pts	+5.2 pts	100%	—
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2	+46.7%	-29.9%	100%	-9.2 pts	-1.1 pts	41%	—
Monthly, hold	R1 + R3	+44.9%	-24.5%	98%	-12.2 pts	+4.2 pts	91%	—
Monthly, hold	R2 + R3	+53.0%	-23.5%	93%	-9.1 pts	+4.5 pts	95%	—
Monthly, hold	R1 + R2 + R3	+44.5%	-24.4%	93%	-13.8 pts	+3.7 pts	89%	—

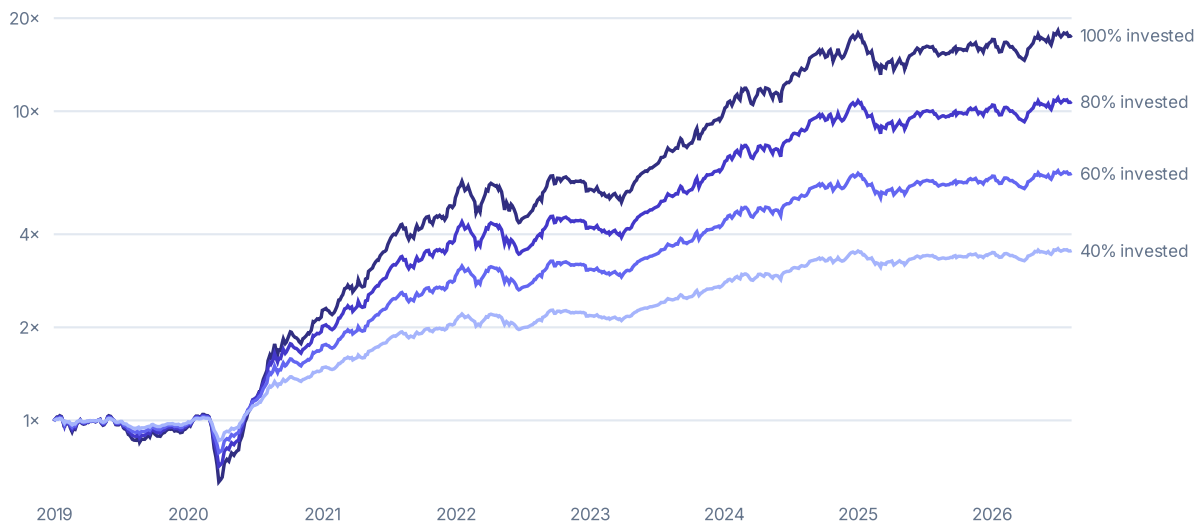
- **The market and small-cap switches (R1, R2) do not work.** They made the worst fall shallower in only a minority of windows, rarely by more than a point in the median, and cost -4.4 to -5.8 points a year (R1). Their one success in the design period was the 2020 crash.
- **The trailing stop (R3) is the only rule that helps with any consistency.** Held monthly as bought, it made the worst fall shallower in 81% of one-year windows and 100% of three-year windows — by a median +2.1 points, and +5.2 in falling markets — for -2.8 points a year of return. Small, but in the right direction almost every time.
- **Nothing reaches -20% on its own.** Even with the stop, 43% of one-year windows fell further than -20%, and every three-year window did.

How much of the money to invest

The one lever that reaches the -20% limit without fitting anything to history: keep only part of the money in the basket and the rest as plain cash in the account — not invested, earning nothing. Every rebalance restores the split by resizing the whole basket. The whole backtest, 31 Dec 2018 – 10 Aug 2026, and 80 one-year and 56 three-year windows started monthly.

Monthly, hold as bought

Invested	Return / yr	Worst fall	1 - yr windows: median return	1 - yr: median fall	1 - yr: worst fall	1 - yr: past -20%	3 - yr: worst fall	3 - yr: past -20%
100%	+46.0%	-41.5%	+55.6%	-18.2%	-43.1%	48%	-44.3%	100%
80%	+36.8%	-33.3%	+43.1%	-14.8%	-34.7%	41%	-35.7%	100%
60%	+27.5%	-25.1%	+31.3%	-11.3%	-26.2%	14%	-26.9%	25%
40%	+18.2%	-16.8%	+20.2%	-7.7%	-17.9%	0%	-18.1%	0%
<i>Nifty 500</i>	<i>+13.3%</i>	<i>-38.3%</i>						



Weekly, reset to equal

Invested	Return / yr	Worst fall	1 - yr windows: median return	1 - yr: median fall	1 - yr: worst fall	1 - yr: past -20%	3 - yr: worst fall	3 - yr: past -20%
100%	+44.3%	-48.0%	+45.2%	-18.3%	-45.0%	45%	-48.0%	100%
80%	+34.9%	-40.2%	+35.1%	-14.8%	-37.5%	29%	-40.2%	59%
60%	+25.7%	-31.5%	+25.5%	-11.2%	-29.3%	14%	-31.5%	25%
40%	+16.8%	-21.9%	+16.5%	-7.6%	-20.3%	3%	-21.9%	9%
<i>Nifty 500</i>	<i>+13.3%</i>	<i>-38.3%</i>						

- **The fall shrinks in proportion, as expected — and so does the return.** Return for each point of worst fall barely moves with the share (monthly: 1.11 at 100%, 1.08 at 40%).
- **40% invested is the share that kept inside -20% throughout**, monthly and held as bought: -16.8% at worst over the whole backtest, and no one-year or three-year window past -20% — while still returning +18.2% a year against the Nifty 500's +13.3%, whose own worst fall was -38.3%.

- **60% is the middle ground:** about +27% a year, a worst fall of -25%, and 14% of one-year windows past -20%.
- As everywhere in this report, these returns are backtest over the period the model was fitted on; the cut in the fall is arithmetic and will hold, the level of return may not.

What changed, and what happens next

On the Returns page

1. **Invested: 100% / 80% / 60% / 40%.** The rest is kept as cash, earning nothing. At 100% every figure is exactly what it was. 2. **"Reset to equal" is now the default** at each rebalance; "Hold as bought" is one click away. 3. **No filter stays the main basket;** the rating and stage filters remain for reading.

The trailing stop, tested forward (P8)

Chosen after all these runs, so no past data can confirm it. It is judged only on published rankings from 28 Sep 2026: the unfiltered Top 20, monthly, held as bought, with and without the 20% stop. Decided at 12 months (end of September 2027): adopt only if its worst fall is at least 2 points shallower and it gives up no more than 5 points of return. A look at 6 months is for information. Written down before the data exists: *docs/Review/p8_trailing_stop_forward_preregistration.md*.

Method: every run uses the dashboard's own Returns engine and filter rules (dashboard/lib/returns.mjs) on the stored weekly backtest rankings, stages and ratings, with split-adjusted closes; stocks are bought at the close of the session after the ranking. Return a year is compound (CAGR) from the first purchase to 30 Sep 2025 (the rolling windows each to their own end, the last on 10 Aug 2026); worst fall is the largest peak-to-bottom drop of the daily value after costs, as if sold that day.